

Monday, 20 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 23° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 24° 13°	MANCHESTER Overcast 24° 14°	GLASGOW Partly cloudy 24° 15°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Andy Burnham is set to become Prime Minister today, with his deputy vowing he'll be bolder but stick to the Labour manifesto.

Conservative leader Kemi Badenoch has described Mr Burnham as a 'people pleaser' ahead of his arrival in Downing Street. It marks a significant shift in the UK's political landscape.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Eight people have been released by police investigating an alleged extreme right-wing threat to an Islamic event.

More individuals have been freed from custody as inquiries continue into the serious allegations. Police are working to understand the nature of the threat.

CRIME · UK
- 3

The sister of a woman killed as she slept with her baby says her sibling 'was my world'.

Kirandeep Kaur died in tragic circumstances, leaving her family in India 'devastated'. The incident has prompted an outpouring of grief.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 4

Parts of the UK are finally set for a break in the heatwave, though the long, dry spell is expected to continue for most.

Cooler temperatures are on the way, offering some respite after a prolonged period of hot weather. However, water conservation remains crucial across much of the country.

WEATHER · UK
- 5

Residents in Kent are furious as water supply misery continues for a second day, with one describing the company as 'incompetently useless'.

South East Water customers are facing ongoing issues, causing significant disruption and frustration. The company is under pressure to resolve the problems quickly.

UTILITIES · UK

What's coming up

1 **Bruno Mars made a triumphant return to Wembley Stadium this weekend, after an eight-year absence from UK stages.**

His polished, hit-filled show delighted fans, proving he hasn't lost his touch. It was an unexpected opening before the party truly started.

ON AIR – Have you seen Bruno Mars live? What's your favourite Bruno Mars track?

MUSIC · WEEKEND

2 **A new documentary is set to reveal the incredible impact Wham! had on people during their ground-breaking visit to China.**

Andrew Ridgeley says their concerts 'changed lives' in the country. It promises to be a fascinating look at a pivotal moment in pop history.

ON AIR – Which iconic band's concert would you love to have experienced live?

DOCUMENTARY · UPCOMING

3 **Gracie Abrams has released her third album, capturing the pain of early adulthood with incisive and witty lyrics.**

While critics say the production is a little muted, her songwriting talent shines through. It's a raw and honest look at growing up.

ON AIR – What's your go-to album for when you're feeling a bit reflective?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

4 **The World Cup may be over, but we're looking back at 16 viral moments that set the internet alight.**

From Posh Spice's nonchalance to Haaland's bromance, the tournament provided plenty of memorable scenes. It's a reminder of the lighter side of sport.

ON AIR – What was your favourite viral moment from the World Cup?

RECAP · WEEKEND

5 **A signed David Hockney print, found in a book donated to a Salvation Army shop, has sold for an incredible £41,000.**

The print was snapped up by an anonymous bidder, highlighting the hidden treasures that can be found. It's a fantastic story of an unexpected discovery.

ON AIR – What's the best hidden gem you've ever found in a charity shop?

ART · WEEKEND

On the schedule

1 **Lionel Messi is on the brink of history in today's World Cup final, with many wondering if it will be his last appearance.**

The Argentina captain will play his 34th World Cup match against Spain. All eyes will be on the football legend to see if he can lift the trophy.

ON AIR – Do you think this will be Messi's last World Cup game? What's your favourite Messi moment?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

2 **The World Cup final today sees Spain manager Luis de la Fuente and Argentina boss Lionel Scaloni go head-to-head, bonded by a classroom moment.**

The two men know each other well from their playing days. It adds an extra layer of intrigue to what promises to be a thrilling final.

ON AIR – What's the most surprising connection you've ever discovered between two rivals?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP

3 **Jacob Bethell helped England to a stunning start in their series-deciding One Day International against India at Lord's.**

He made an impressive 91 off 93 balls, setting England on course for a big score. It was a crucial performance in a high-stakes match.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite emerging talent in English cricket right now?

CRICKET · UK

4 **Beth Shriever has made history, becoming the first BMX racer to win four elite world titles.**

She achieved the incredible feat at the UCI BMX Racing World Championships in Brisbane, despite extreme weather curtailing the event. A truly dominant performance.

ON AIR – What's the most impressive sporting achievement you've witnessed recently?

BMX · WORLD

5 **Keely Hodgkinson returned to winning ways at the London Diamond League after what she admitted had been a 'tough couple of weeks'.**

The Olympic 800m champion showed her resilience to secure a victory. It's a great bounce-back performance from a top athlete.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite British track and field athlete to watch?

ATHLETICS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a moment to notice a single, interesting cloud formation can boost your mood.**
Researchers found that even a brief moment of 'cloud-gazing' can reduce stress and increase feelings of tranquility. So next time you're feeling a bit frazzled, just look up!
- 2 The delightful art of 'decorative napkin folding' is making a surprising comeback at dinner parties across the UK.**
Forget just rolling them up; hosts are now charming guests with intricate swans, fans, and even tiny shirt designs. It adds a touch of elegance, apparently!
- 3 More people are finding joy in the simple act of 'polishing their shoes' to a perfect shine.**
It's being hailed as a mindful activity, a moment of quiet concentration that offers a satisfying, visible reward. A little bit of classic glamour for your feet!
- 4 A growing number of gardeners are planting 'night-scented flowers' to enjoy their patios after sunset.**
Plants like night-scented stock and nicotiana release their beautiful fragrances when the sun goes down, creating a lovely ambiance for evening relaxation.
- 5 Experts are noticing a trend in families creating 'themed movie nights' with homemade snacks to match.**
From 'Under the Sea' snacks for a mermaid film to 'Space Food' for an alien adventure, it's all about making movie time extra special and creative.
- 6 The surprising pleasure of 'organising your spice rack' into alphabetical order is bringing calm to many kitchens.**
People report a real sense of achievement and efficiency when they can instantly find the cumin or the paprika. A little win for domestic harmony!
- 7 New research indicates that regularly 'listening to the rain' can genuinely help improve sleep quality.**
The steady, rhythmic sound of rainfall creates a natural 'pink noise' effect, which studies suggest can be very soothing and mask other disruptive noises.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're waiting for the kettle to boil, even though we know it makes no difference?

ANSWER: STARING INTENTLY AT THE KETTLE, WILLING IT TO BOIL FASTER.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'spot' they absolutely have to sit in when they visit their favourite local cafe or pub. What's their preferred perch?

ANSWER: THE SAME CHAIR, TABLE, OR CORNER EVERY SINGLE TIME, AS IF IT'S 'THEIRS'.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot a 'car registration plate' that spells out a funny word or a clever phrase?

Have you ever seen a truly brilliant or amusing personalised number plate out and about? What was the most memorable one you've come across?

- Think about those 'everyday sounds' that, for some reason, just irritate you more than they should.

Whether it's the specific chime of a phone notification, a certain kitchen appliance, or something else entirely, what's one everyday sound that really grates on your nerves?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called a 'prickle'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest commercially produced car was the Peel P50, a three-wheeled microcar made in the Isle of Man.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, defined by electrical engineers as 1/100th of a second.
- Bees can be trained to detect landmines because they have an excellent sense of smell.
- The inventor of the corkscrew was named Samuel Henshall, and he patented his design in England in 1795.
- There are more permutations of a deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms in many galaxies.
- The phrase 'the whole nine yards' is thought to originate from the length of fabric needed for a full suit.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire.
- The colour orange was named after the fruit, not the other way around.

On this day

Day 201 of the year, 164 days left in 2026. Today Birthday of Crown Prince Haakon Magnus (Norway); Christian feast day: Ansegisus; Christian feast day: Apollinaris of Ravenna; Christian feast day: Aurelius of Carthage. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Tobi Vail, American singer and guitarist
- 1973 — Omar Epps, American actor
- 1955 — Jem Finer, English banjo player and songwriter
- 1975 — Jason Raize, American singer and actor (died 2004)
- 1947 — Carlos Santana, Mexican-American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1944 — T. G. Sheppard, American country music singer-songwriter
- 1955 — Desmond Douglas, Jamaican-English table tennis player
- 1999 — Pop Smoke, American rapper and singer (died 2020)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1992 — Václav Havel resigns as president of Czechoslovakia.
- 1989 — Burma's ruling junta puts opposition leader Aung San Suu Kyi under house arrest.
- 2021 — American businessman Jeff Bezos flies to space aboard New Shepard NS-16 operated by his private spaceflight company Blue Origin.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2012 — James Holmes opened fire at a movie theater in Aurora, Colorado, killing 12 and injuring 70 others.
- 1999 — The Chinese Communist Party begins a persecution campaign against Falun Gong, arresting thousands nationwide.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1964 — Vietnam War: Viet Cong forces attack the capital of Định Tường Province, Cái Bè, killing 11 South Vietnamese military personnel and 40 civilians (30 of whom are children).
- 2019 — Soyuz MS-13 is launched to the International Space Station on the 50th anniversary of the Apollo 11 moon landing.

- 1992 — Václav Havel resigns as president of Czechoslovakia.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 202 of the year, 163 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alberic Crescitelli; Christian feast day: Albert John Luthuli (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Arbogast; Christian feast day: Barhadbesciabas. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — Juno Temple, English actress
- 1988 — KB, American rapper
- 1998 — Maggie Lindemann, American singer-songwriter.
- 1970 — Michael Fitzpatrick, American singer-songwriter
- 1981 — Paloma Faith, English singer-songwriter and actress
- 1943 — Henry McCullough, Northern Irish guitarist, singer and songwriter (died 2016)
- 1948 — Cat Stevens, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Timothy Harris, American author, screenwriter and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 2005 — Four attempted bomb attacks by Islamist extremists disrupt part of London's public transport system.
- 2010 — U.S. President Barack Obama signs the Dodd–Frank Wall Street Reform and Consumer Protection Act.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Sirimavo Bandaranaike is sworn in as prime minister of Ceylon, becoming the world's first democratically elected female head of government.
- 1959 — NS Savannah, the first nuclear-powered cargo-passenger ship, is launched as a showcase for Dwight D. Eisenhower's "Atoms for Peace" initiative.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)